TryHackMe Writeup: Search Skills

Field	Details
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Room	Search Skills
Room link	https://tryhackme.com/room/searchskillscS?utm_campaign=social_share&utm_medium=social&utm_content=share-completed-room&utm_source=copy&sharerId=698d81bc7977c1741b32e1c8
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Objective

Learn how to find reliable information quickly using search engines, specialised search services and technical documentation. In security work you are always looking something up, so this is a skill you use daily.

What I did, task by task

Evaluating information sources

- Not everything online is correct. Before trusting a page I check who wrote it, when it was last updated and whether other sources say the same thing.
- Official documentation and vendor pages are more reliable than random forum posts.

Searching with search engines

- Learnt the useful operators: quotes for an exact phrase, site: to search inside one website, - to remove a word and filetype: to look for a specific file type.
- Pasting an exact error message in quotes is often the fastest way to find a fix.

Specialised search engines

- Shodan and Censys search for internet-connected devices and exposed services, not web pages.
- VirusTotal checks files, URLs, domains and hashes against many antivirus engines.
- Have I Been Pwned shows whether an email address appeared in a known data breach.

Vulnerability databases

- CVE gives every known vulnerability a unique ID, NVD adds severity scores, and Exploit-DB lists public exploits for them.

Technical documentation

- Man pages (man <command>), --help and the official docs of a tool or product are the first place to look when I don't know how something works.

Commands and tools used

Command / Tool	What it does
man <command>	Opens the manual page of a command
<tool> --help	Shows quick usage options of a tool
Shodan / Censys	Find exposed devices and services on the internet
VirusTotal	Check a file, URL or hash for malicious detections
NVD / Exploit-DB	Look up CVE details, severity and public exploits

Key takeaways

- Good searching saves a lot of time and is a skill on its own.
- Operators like quotes, site: and filetype: make results far more precise.
- Always cross-check a source before relying on it.
- Shodan, VirusTotal, NVD and Exploit-DB are tools I will use again in SOC work.

Why this matters for a SOC role

A SOC analyst constantly checks suspicious IPs, hashes and domains, and looks up CVEs for alerts. Knowing where to look, and which source to trust, makes triage faster and more accurate.

Proof of completion

